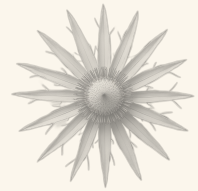




AMOREBIETA · EUSKAL HERRIA



Built to Last

A guide for Guillermo & Pilar



The audiobook

Scan to listen, chapter by chapter 

Your honest check-in

No judgement, nobody sees this but you. Answer fast and from the gut. Every **yes** is not a failure, it is a lever you can actually move. Tick the boxes.

Do you often eat late, after about 19:30, and go to bed on a full belly? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Do you reach for a little late-night snack on the sofa, even when you are not truly hungry? ☐ Yes ☐ No

After dinner, around 20:00 or 21:00, do you often reach for something sweet, a bit of chocolate or a small treat? ☐ Yes ☐ No

The second your stomach growls, do you feel you have to eat, even soon after a full meal? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Do you keep eating because you still feel hungry, when really it is just appetite, the mouth wanting more? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Do you drink your calories, a beer, a Kalimotxo or a sugary soft drink, more often than you would like? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Do you almost always take the lift, and avoid the stairs whenever you can? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Outside of work, do you move very little on a normal day? ☐ Yes ☐ No

☐ **Could you imagine starting small, changing just one or two of these, this week?**

Calorie sheet

For _____

Age _____

Height _____ cm

Weight _____ kg

Sex _____

A normal day _____

Your base need, what you burn in a day

_____ **kcal**

To lose weight, eat **under** your base need. For a slow, steady drop, aim for about _____ **to**
_____ **kcal a day** (a few hundred below).

Important: stay under your base need. A few hundred below means losing slowly and steadily, the kind that lasts and does not bounce back.

If that feels too slow and you want it faster, the guide has a "**Want it faster?**" section, but it asks for a lot more willpower and discipline.

This is a solid estimate, not a lab reading. The scale is the real test: eat to it for 2 to 3 weeks and adjust.

Weight today: _____ **kg** My daily target: _____ **kcal** Date: _____

It was never about the food

If you forget everything else in this guide, keep these two pages. It all comes down to a handful of truths, and a couple of laughs. Read them slowly, read them out loud, and come back to them on the hard days.

It was never about the food.

Of everything in here, this is the deepest part: it is not about food. Not rules, not another diet, not gritting your teeth at the dinner table. It is a deep shift in the way your mind works, and a change in the way you live. That is the foundation, and if you build on sand, no recipe on earth will hold. Get the mind right, and the food quietly takes care of itself. (And that famous line, that breakfast is the most important meal of the day? Never science. It was a cereal advert from the early 1900s, invented to sell more cornflakes.)

The magic is hiding in the hunger.

The magic you are looking for is in the very thing you keep running from: a little hunger. Your body runs on two fuels, the food you just ate and the fat you carry around. (The fat we all carry, Guillermo, not a personal attack, I have seen your arms.) Feed it every couple of hours and it stays lazy and never touches the reserves. Let a little normal hunger back in, and it remembers how to burn its own fat. Your ancestors did not roll out of the cave to a full plate, they hunted the mammoth on an empty stomach and ate after. That little hunger is not the enemy. It is the door.

You are the captain.

Right now, when a craving shows up, your body snaps its fingers and you obey. The body is steering the ship, and you, the captain, have quietly let go of the wheel. Take it back. A craving is just an impulse, it has no power of its own, and the only one with real power here is you. Win that one fight inside your head and you have not just beaten one craving, you have beaten all of them, and every single win literally rewires your brain.

Tell the cheesecake to go home.

Picture it: you are out at the Chinese restaurant you love, and a gorgeous little whisky cheesecake is sitting on the table, batting its eyes at you. You look it dead in the eye, you smile, and you tell it: "*Vete a tu puta casa.*" Go home, you are not invited tonight. And when the bill comes and you never even ordered it, you sit back, grin, and think: I won, because I am stronger than you. That is exactly what being the captain feels like.

Systems beat willpower.

Willpower is a small bucket of water, and by the evening it is almost always empty, which is why plans built on willpower alone fall apart at ten at night on the sofa. The people who make it are not stronger than you, and it is not iron discipline. They simply built systems, so that when temptation shows up, willpower never has to save the day. You do not keep the biscuits out of your mouth, you keep them out of the house.

A craving is a wave, not a wall.

A craving feels like a wall you have to climb, but it is really a wave. It rises, it peaks, and if you do not feed it, it breaks and rolls away, usually in just a few minutes. You do not have to beat it. You just have to outlast it: drink a glass of water, make a tea, step outside, and let it pass. And remember, you cannot out-train a fork, not even up on the scaffolding, so the real work is here, in the small daily choices.

Feed the stronger you.

There is an old line, and it is true: *the spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak*. Inside you there is a stronger version and a weaker version of yourself, and both are completely real. Every time you keep your word to yourself, the strong one grows. Every time you break it, the weak one grows instead. Nothing you do is ever wasted, it is always feeding one of the two. So the only question that really matters is this: which one do you want to feed?

Stop doing the same thing.

"Insanity is doing the same thing over and over again and expecting a different result." That was Einstein, and before Pilar reaches for the frying pan, nobody here is calling anyone crazy, we have all done it. But a seed cannot stay a seed and become a tree at the same time. Something has to break open. So stand in front of the mirror, look yourself in the eye, and say it like you mean it: this is not how I want to feel, and I am going to change it. I brought my body here, so I can bring it back. Food does not control me. I am stronger than my impulses.

You do not have to be perfect. You just have to keep coming back. You are stronger than your impulses, so today, prove it to yourself one more time.



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The 45-day plan

Print it, put it on the fridge next to your why, and mark it with a pen. A winning day is simply a day you pushed a few of these the right way.

What a winning day looks like

- ☐ I stayed under my daily calorie need.
- ☐ No little snacks or sweets today.
- ☐ Less oil in the cooking, like we agreed.
- ☐ At least 5,000 steps, or a 30 minute walk.
- ☐ Kitchen closed after dinner, nothing after 7:30.

Tick off your 45 days

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45

Your weight, every 7 days

Once a week, same morning, after the toilet and before breakfast. Write it in by hand. Only the trend over the weeks counts, never a single day.

Checkpoint	Date	Peso Pilar (kg)	Peso Guillermo (kg)
Start · Day 1			
Day 7			
Day 15 			
Day 22			
Day 30 			
Day 37			
End · Day 45 			

Your contract

Read it together, write in your numbers, and sign it by hand. That signature is what makes it stick.

Why a contract, and why now? Most people only change when it is already too late, after the heart scare, the bad diagnosis, the moment the doctor turns serious. You are doing it **before** that, while it is still a choice and not an emergency. That is exactly what this contract is for.

Put something on the line

A promise with nothing at stake is easy to break, so put something real on the line together: money you would hate to lose, or a trip or treat you both want. One rule, and it is what makes you a team: **you only win if you both win, and if one of you quits, you both lose it**. Now you are not just fighting your own cravings, you are carrying each other.

Our Commitment

We, Guillermo and Pilar, on this day _____, make this promise to ourselves and to each other. Truly and honestly, with our whole hearts, we commit to this challenge, because deep down we know we want this, and the weak voice in us is not the one steering the ship:

- We will be **stronger than our cravings**. A craving is just a wave, and we let it pass.
- We will **not give in to our impulses**. An impulse has no power. We are the captains of our ship.
- Our **systems are stronger than our willpower**, because we know our willpower will run dry, and our systems will not.
- We will **eat below the calories our bodies truly need**, most days, without starving ourselves.
- When the impulse hits, we **stay strong, go to our habits, and read our why again**.
- We will **weigh ourselves regularly and write it down**, to see the honest truth.

We make this commitment **as a team**, for _____ **days** (we choose 30 or 45), because changing a lifetime system is hard and deserves a real promise. We do it now, on purpose, before life forces us to.

What we put on the line, together:

Guillermo

Pilar

Your Power Page

The one that matters most 

One bad hour does not mean the next one has to be bad, and one bad day does not doom the next.

The slip is not what beats you. **Giving up after it is.** It is not how often you fall. It is **how often you get back up.** The people who make it got up one more time than they went down. Everyone falls. Maybe the sweets won seven nights, so they got up and fought back on the eighth.

When you slip, do not be hard on yourself. Just say: "**I am only practicing,**" and start again. Next meal, next morning, next day. Getting up, again and again, **is the muscle.**

So do not chase miracles, **chase consistency.** One day the change is not a diet you are surviving, it is simply **who you are now.**

For the fighter in you

★ Nobody is coming to do this for me. I save myself.

★ I do not negotiate with my weaker self. Ever.

★ I am the captain of my ship. My cravings do not steer me.

★ The pain of discipline is lighter than the pain of regret.

★ I can do hard things. I do them every day at work.

★ I am not finished. I am just getting started.

For the loving heart in you

★ I am worth taking care of. My body deserves my love.

★ I treat my body with kindness, not punishment.

★ Every good choice is a gift to the people I love.

★ I am becoming my healthiest self, gently and surely.

★ I keep my word to myself, because I matter.

★ I want to be here, strong and well, for many years.

You are not alone in this. Guillermo and Pilar, you have each other. On the hard days, one of you carries the other. That is the strongest system of all.